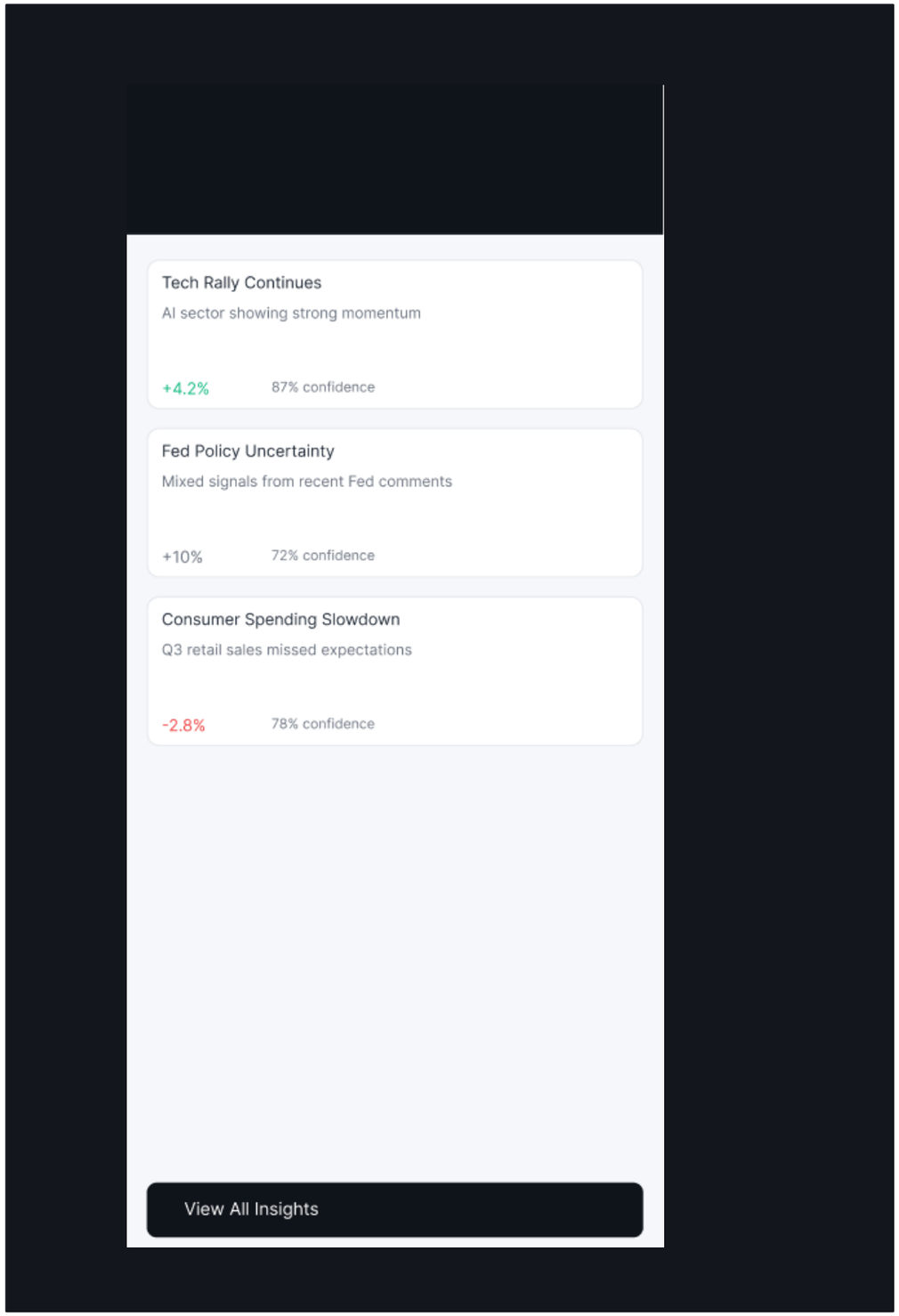
SELECTED WORK · LEAD UX DESIGNER

Michael Thibodeau

Two projects: an AI screener for active traders, and an AI-assisted mobile trading app.



Contents

Two projects, one process

Select a project to jump to it.

01 FinViz AI Screener

Problem, decisions and what comes next

02 Meridian Navigator

Trade and AI flows, designed states, trade-offs

03 Leadership and process

How I set direction, the calls, and the status

04 Next steps

What I would do next

FinViz: cut sign-up to Elite from 42 days to 21

The target came from the case brief. It has not been measured yet.

42 → 21

days from sign-up to Elite, the target for new traders

Measured: not yet. Validation is planned (slide 7).

PROBLEM

New traders take 42 days to see why Elite is worth paying for. The screener gives no reasons, and the list forgets them.

DECISION

An AI layer turns the trader's own picks into a working screen, and explains each finding with its source.

RESULT

Hi-fi concepts for one trading day. Outcome measurement is planned, not done.

My role, and where the AI stops

I led discovery, strategy and the Figma design. AI agents helped with drafting.

PROBLEM

Build a screen from three example tickers, explain why each row matched, and check whether the trader’s reasons still hold.

DECISION

The AI verifies the trader’s own criteria. It never originates buy or sell advice. Attributed analyst views sit behind a flag, pending compliance.

RESULT

A design that a compliance review can act on, with the advice line written down before the screens were built.

Decisions, including the ones I reversed

Each call came from a review. The reasoning is kept in the full deck.

DECISION 1

No chat box first

Imports and examples lead. Success must be timely, relevant and actionable.

DECISION 2

Set the advice line

The AI never originates advice. Attributed analyst views sit behind a flag, pending compliance.

DECISION 3

Lead with the trading day

Three concepts competed. The one that followed his real routine won.

DECISION 4

Map today’s onboarding first

A live-site walk found an existing 7-day trial and 1-minute delayed quotes. Two assumptions were wrong.

Leadership: how I set direction and made calls

Evidence from the project record, with dates where the record has them.

SET THE DIRECTION

Logged 31 points from a four-reviewer review on 30 Sept. The organizing goal moved to time to first success.

RECONCILED, NOT OVERWRITTEN

Teammates' screens kept their best ideas. Only what broke the rules was cut.

MADE THE CALLS, DATED

Lead calls on 23 and 30 Sept, each written with its reason: no chat box first, set the advice line, lead with the trading day.

KEPT OPEN DECISIONS VISIBLE

Meridian: open questions and decisions logged on the FigJam board, and settled items marked separately.

SET THE RULES ONCE

Rules in the project brief made every AI draft start compliant.

What I would validate next

Planned, not run. Nothing here is a result yet.

1

Think-aloud

5 users, on the first evening and the board

2

Alert diary study

Two weeks of real alerts, logged by participants

3

Labeled chart checks

Weekly audits, with a target of under 1% wrong among clear detections

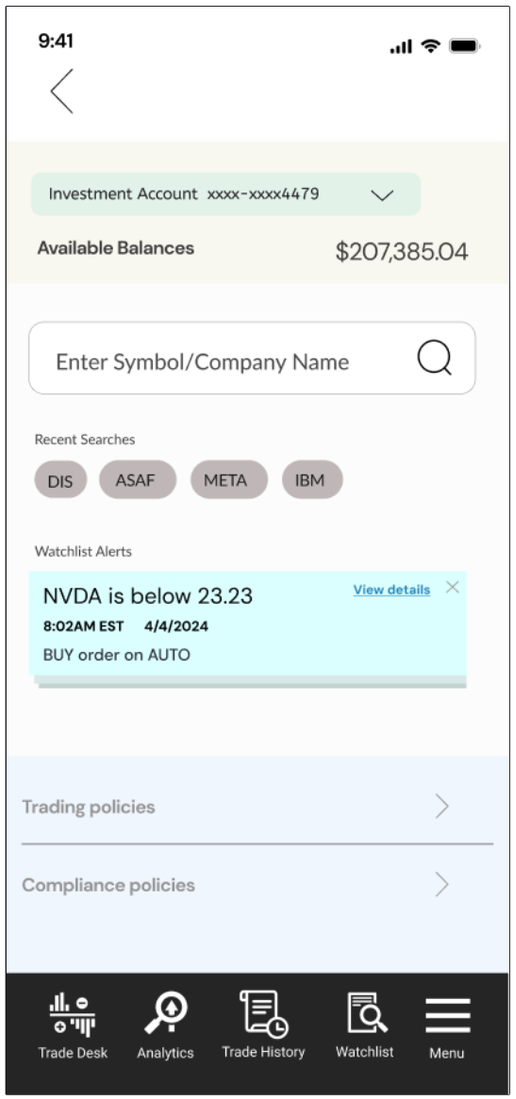
4

Compliance review

The advice line and the trial timing, before any launch

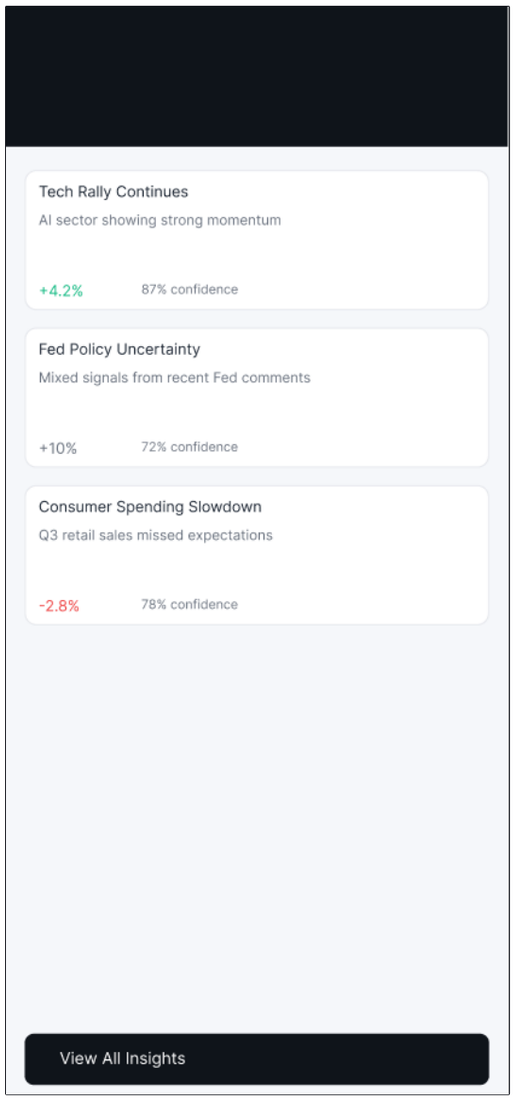
Meridian: a trade and AI flow, prototyped in Figma

Five core screens, each answering one question. Outcomes are not yet measured.



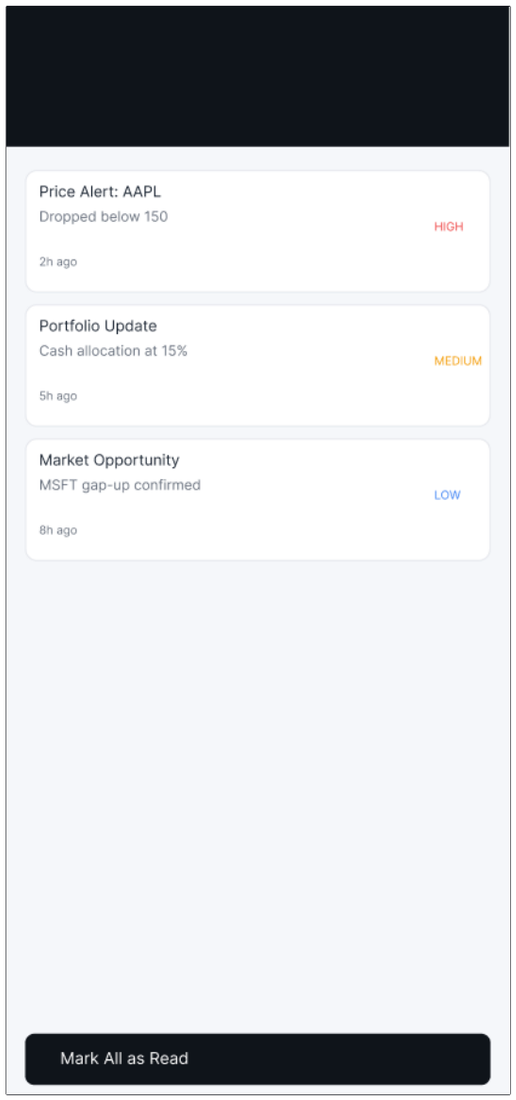
Dashboard

What do I own today?



Insight

What moved, and why?



Guard

What needs my attention?

PROBLEM

Research, order entry and monitoring live in separate tools.

DECISION

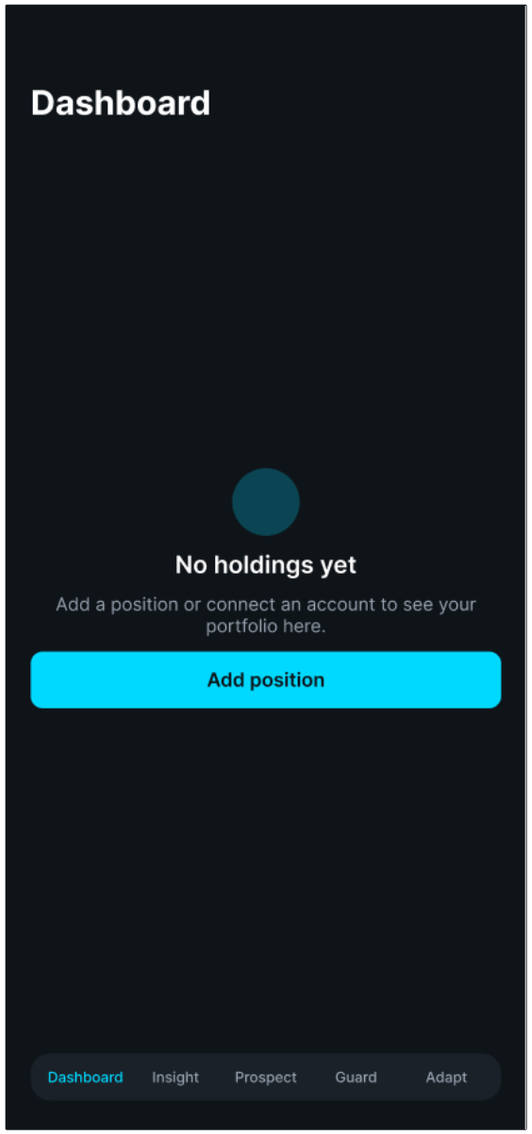
Put trade flows and AI screens in one app, with mock data.

RESULT

A clickable prototype. Outcomes not yet measured.

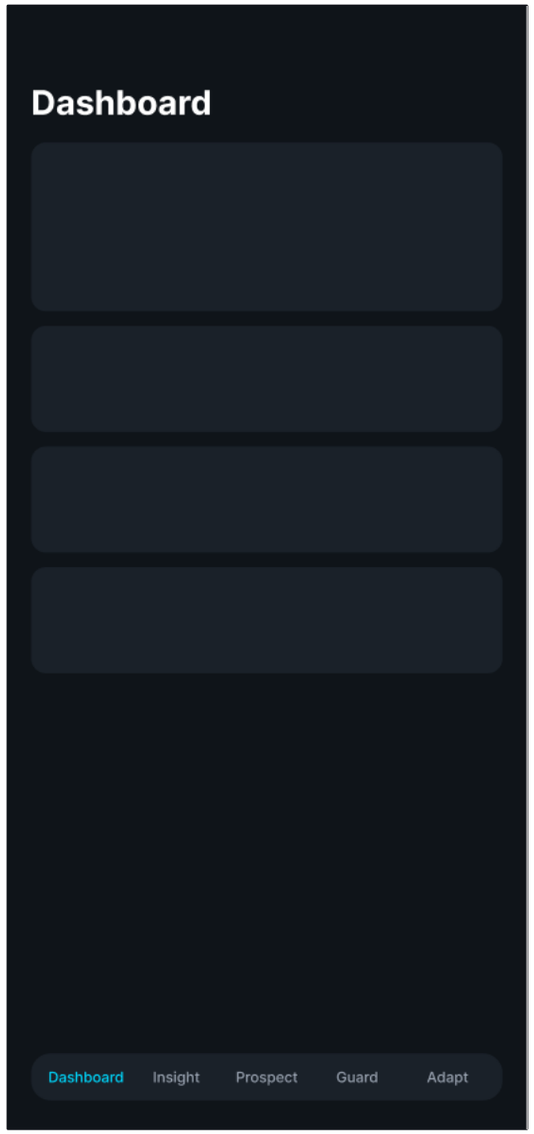
Designing for the states that mocked data hides

Dashboard in four states. The other four screens follow the same pattern.



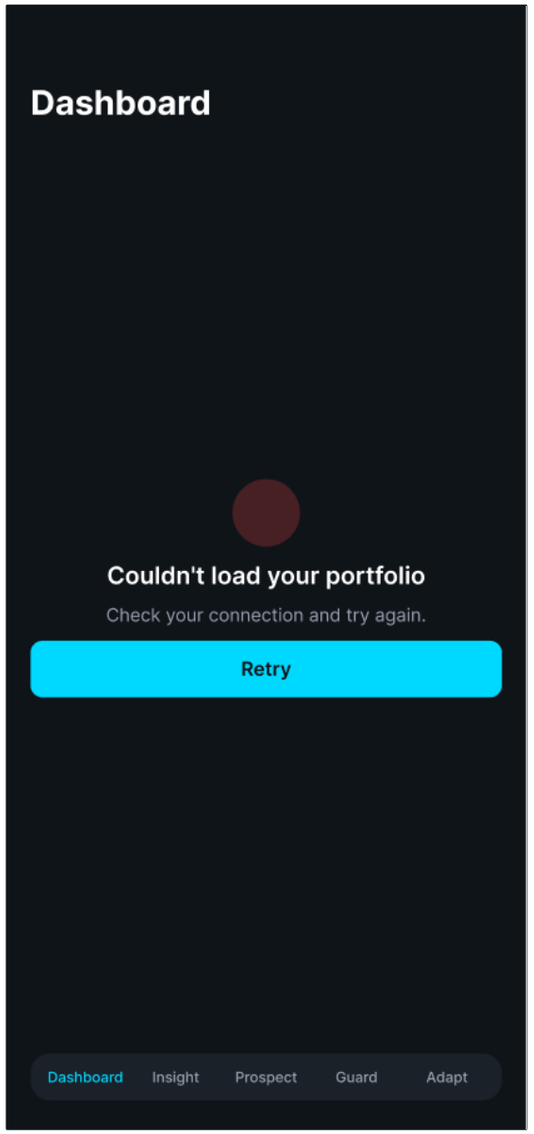
Empty

No holdings yet. One clear next step.



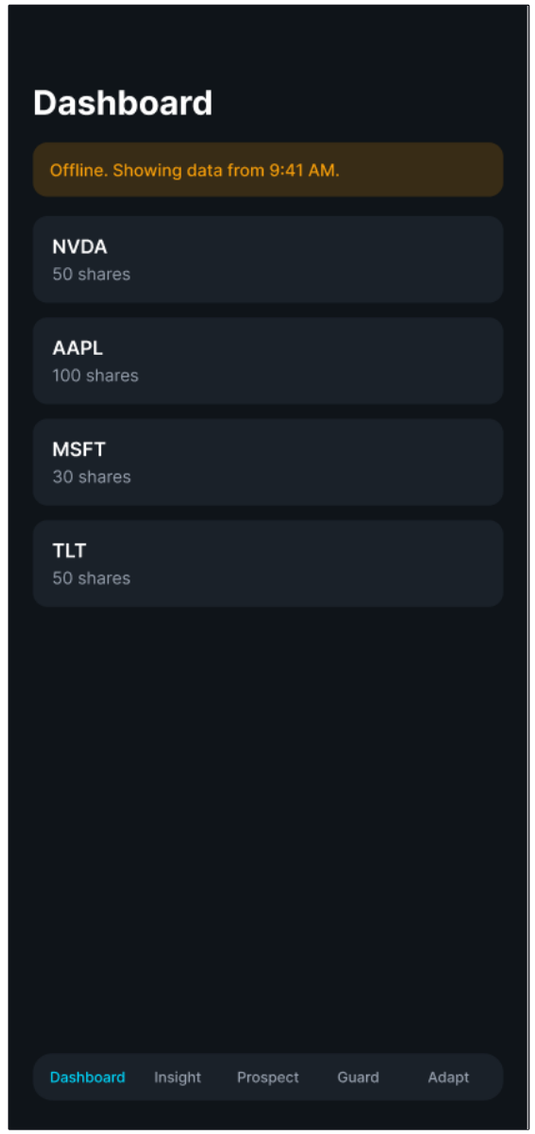
Loading

Skeleton cards hold the layout while data loads.



Error

Says what failed and offers a retry.



Offline

Warns that data is stale and shows the last update.

Trade-offs I chose, and what they cost

Each call is stated with its cost. Open items are marked as open.

DECISION 1

Keep both share and dollar entry

Unclear which model new investors prefer. Two flows to maintain, and open for testing.

DECISION 2

Mock API with a delay

Lets us test flows and loading states without a backend. Real timing and errors are untested.

DECISION 3

Adapt suggests buys and sells

It is the screen’s job, but the wording needs compliance review before release.

DECISION 4

Five tabs, one home screen

Scannable areas, with trading one tap away. AI screens compete with trade entry for attention.

How I work, across both projects

Self-assessed status. No interviews or usability tests have run yet.

1

Frame

DONE

Problem, scope and assumptions written down before design.

2

Hypothesize

DRAFTED

Personas and principles, marked as untested.

3

Map flows

DRAFTED

Flows and screens for the core job, drafted in Figma.

4

Design system

IN PROGRESS

Shared tokens for Figma and code. Component library not yet audited.

5

Design states

DRAFTED

Empty, loading, error and offline states.

6

Validate

PLANNED

Interviews, usability tests and compliance review.

Next steps

What I would do next

The order that unblocks the most work.

- Run five to eight interviews to test the personas
- Usability-test the share and dollar flows
- Set metric targets with stakeholders and measure them
- Complete the compliance review of trade and AI copy

Get in touch

[Add email]
[Add phone]
[Add portfolio URL]